Sea monsters

Many reptiles are suited to ocean life. Some have a powerful heart that keeps the blood pumping during deep dives in cold water, and glands to remove sea salt from their bodies.

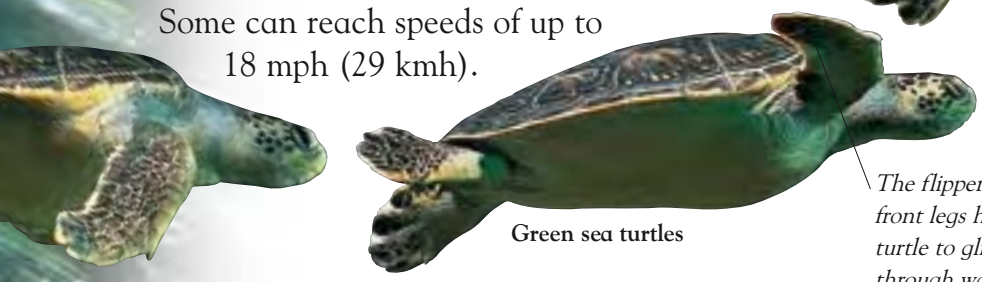


The wetter the better

Sea snakes have a flattened tail, which they use as a paddle for moving in water – a little like a boat's oar. They are superb swimmers, but find it extremely difficult to get around on land.

Slick and quick

These sea turtles have large front flippers and light, flat, smoothly shaped shells. Such features help them to move quickly through water. Some can reach speeds of up to 18 mph (29 kmh).



The back feet are used for steering – like the rudder on a boat.

The flipper-shaped front legs help the turtle to glide through water.

Green sea turtles



Tough at the top

Most turtles have hard, plated shells on their backs, but – as its name suggests – the giant leatherback turtle is different. It has a tough-looking shell made of thick, leathery skin.

Reptile file

- Sea snakes are the most poisonous snakes in the world.
- Sea turtles cry salty tears. This is to get rid of the extra, unwanted salt they swallow as they swim and feed.
- The leatherback turtle can grow to 6 ft (1.8 m) in length.